The Keerthana App

Keerthana Music School — a shared home for our notation

A quick walkthrough of how it all works

keerthana-music.github.io/library

What the app is

Master Archive

The school's canonical notation — one shared library of every piece Akka teaches.

Personal Library

Your own copy, in your Drive. Add, favourite, and receive pieces shared with you.

Concert Planner

Build a programme: line up pieces, set the shruthi, open notation, then print.

Resources*

Theory, glossary, newsletters and links. Plus Attendance — for teachers.

Everything lives in Google Drive. You open the app in a browser and sign in with Google.

** Resources is planned for a later version (v2); Attendance appears there for the Teacher role.*

Two kinds of archive

Two separate things — keep them clear and everything else follows.

MASTER archive

The school's one canonical library.
Bare on purpose: each piece is just its name, its raga / tala / composer, and the notation PDF — nothing else.

Curated by Akka + the Admin group.
Students never see this whole list.

PERSONAL archive

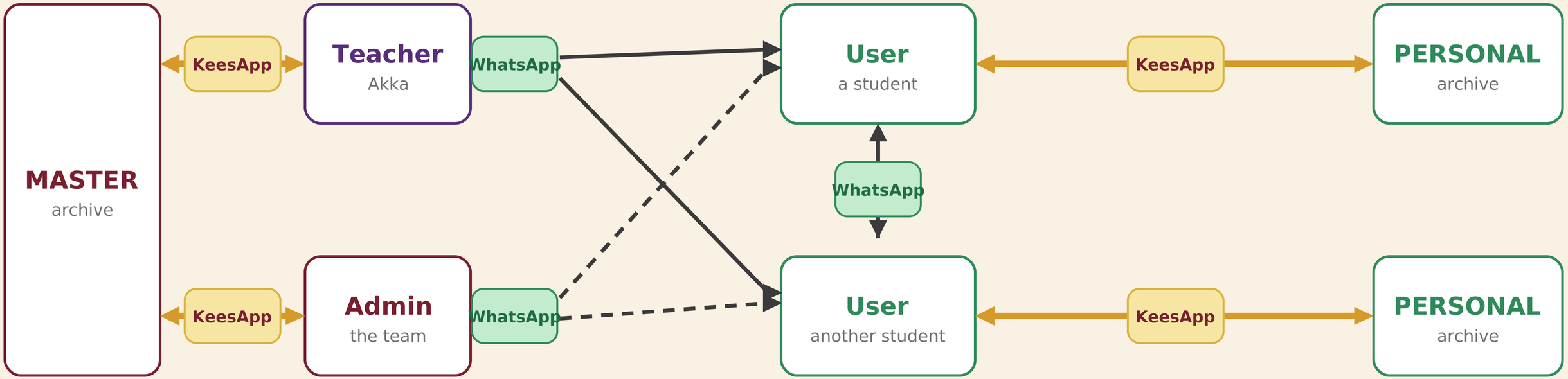
Your own library, in your own Google Drive. Everyone has one.

Add what you're learning, import a batch, or receive pieces shared with you.

Yours to arrange; no one else sees it.

How everyone connects

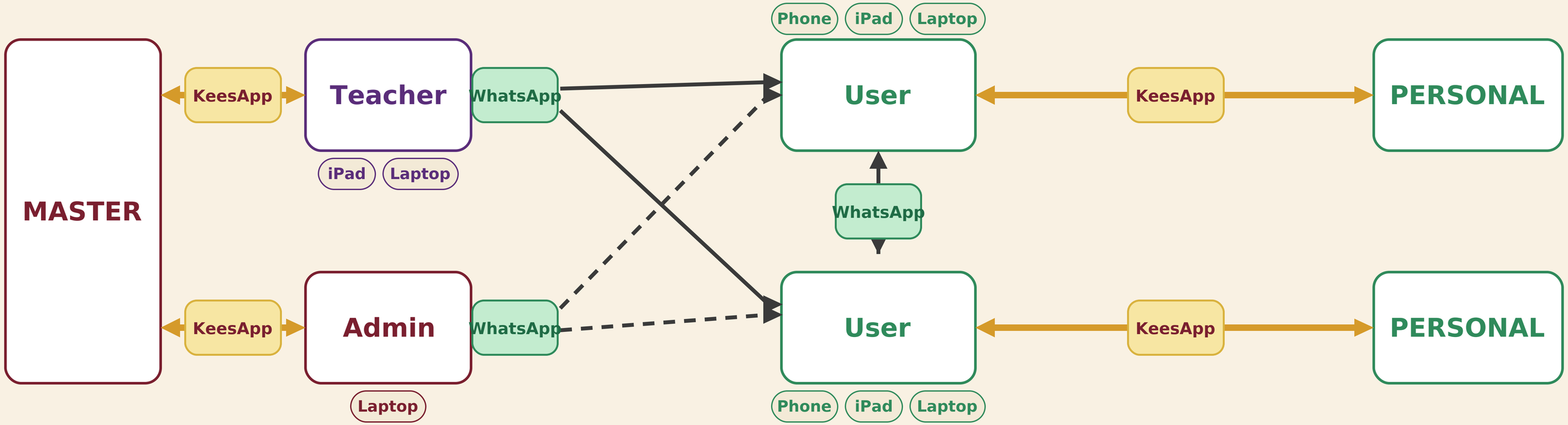
The app links each person to their archive; WhatsApp carries a shared piece from one person to another.



Solid arrows are the Teacher's shares, dashed are the team's — and students can pass a piece to each other too.

The architecture

The same picture, with the screens each person uses — and KeesApp is simply your Google sign-in.



WHERE THE CODE LIVES

The app (front-end)
The whole app UI, on RP's GitHub Pages (keerthana-music) — free HTTPS.

The backend
The browser talks to Drive directly; one small Apps Script serves the catalog.

Storage & cost
Everything in Google Drive. No servers to run — free.

Signing in

Everyone starts the same way: open the app, sign in with Google.

1. **Sign in with Google**
   Tap “Sign in with Google” and pick your account.

2. **Choose your role**
   Teacher and Admin can select roles; a User has only one role.

3. **Allow Drive, pick Master**
   Teacher and Admin allow the app to access Drive and select the Master folder.

The Teacher role

Akka has the full master library — to teach from, and to keep in shape.

Teach from it

Browse & search the whole master

Filter by raga, tala, composer or type

Favourite pieces; plan concert programmes

Share any piece to the class (a link)

Curate it

Everything the Admin group can do:

add and bulk-import into the master,

edit details, remove pieces —

so she can curate as she teaches.

The Admin role

The Admin group's job: turn Akka's digitised notation into the master library.

1. **Scan / gather**
   A folder of notation PDFs, each named by the piece.

2. **Bulk import**
   In the app: ⇧ Import, select the PDFs (⌘/Ctrl-A grabs all).

3. **Auto-name & review**
   The app guesses raga / composer; you check the review list.

4. **Fix & tidy**
   Edit any wrong details; remove accidental duplicates.

The User role

Students and parents each keep their own personal library — nobody else sees it.

Add a piece
Pick one notation PDF from your Drive, fill in the details.

Bulk import
Bring in several PDFs at once; the app auto-names them.

Receive a share
Tap a link Akka sends — the piece drops into your library.

Favourite
Star the pieces you're working on for quick filtering.

Plan a concert
Build a running order from your own pieces.

Share your own
Send a piece on to a classmate.

Getting pieces in

Three ways a piece gets into an archive — master or personal, same idea.

Add

One PDF

Pick a single notation PDF and add its details. Best for the odd one-off.

Bulk import

Many PDFs

Select several PDFs at once. Tip: pick the files, not the folder.
The workhorse for big batches.

Share import

A tapped link

Someone shares a piece; you tap the link and it's added automatically. No files to pick.

Fixing & removing

Every piece has a pencil button — to fix its details, or to take it out.

✎ Edit details

Fix the piece name, raga, tala, composer or type.

Handy when the auto-namer during a bulk import guessed wrong.

✕ Remove from archive

A safe delete: the piece is moved to a “marked for deletion” folder.

It is NOT gone — an admin empties that folder in Drive later, if ever.

Sharing to the class

Sharing to the class is one tap for Akka, one tap for the student.



The notation opens for anyone with the link — so it just works in class, on any phone.

The concert planner

The Concert tab turns a set of pieces into a printable running order.

1. **Add pieces**
   Tap + on any piece to drop it into the concert list.

2. **Order them**
   Move pieces up and down into your programme order.

3. **Set the shruthi**
   Note the pitch for each item, right on the list.

4. **Open the notation**
   Each item has a document button to open its PDF.

5. **Print**
   Print a clean running order for the day.

What keeps it safe

A few quiet rules keep the whole thing safe and tidy.

Nothing is ever hard-deleted

Remove only moves a piece aside; you delete for good in Drive, deliberately.

The master is the single source of truth

One canonical library. Personal copies come from it, not the other way round.

Students never see the master song list

They only see their own library and what's shared with them — no pestering for untaught songs.

Shared notation opens for anyone with the link

So class sharing just works; but only pieces Akka chooses to share go out.

Button cheat-sheet

The buttons you'll see, and what they do.

Share
Send a piece as a link

Favourite
Star for quick filtering

Add to concert
Drop into the concert list

Edit / remove
Fix details or take it out

Open notation
Open the PDF

Add
Add one PDF ("+ Add")

Import
Bulk import PDFs ("⇧ Import")

Master folder
Point Admin/Teacher at the master

Rebuild
Re-scan the master into the list

Switch role
Change Teacher / Admin / User

What's next

Where we'd like to take it — for your thoughts, Akka

Two ideas we think matter most, then the longer road.

Two things we'd fix first

Right now anyone with the link can use the app for their own list. Two changes make it truly ours.

1 Make it members-only

Today the link is open to anyone.
We'd limit sign-in to Keerthana
families only — an enrolled list Akka
(or the Admin group) keeps up to date.

This also lays the ground for
the attendance tool later, which
only makes sense for enrolled students.

2 Make starting easy

Asking a busy parent to organise 20–30
of their own PDFs is a non-starter —
they'll say “can't be bothered”.

Instead: let families browse Akka's
master, tick the pieces they want, and
request them. An admin sends back one
link that fills their library in a tap.

Members-only access

So the app is for the Keerthana community, not the whole internet.

An enrolled list

Only families on the school's list can sign in and use the app.

Enrolment

When a student joins, Akka or an admin adds them — they're in.

Un-enrolment

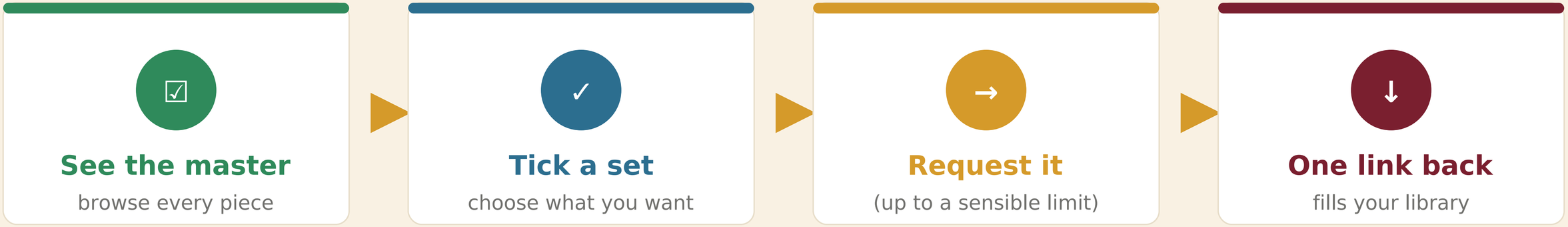
When someone leaves, they come off the list and access ends.

Why it matters

It's the foundation for the attendance tool and anything member-only.

An easier way to start

Families build their library from Akka's master, instead of hunting their own files.



Three pieces make this work: a visible master, a “request a set” button, and sharing many pieces in one link.

What we'd build for it

Each piece is small on its own; together they remove the setup barrier.

1 A visible master

Families can see the school's full archive (browse & search) — without it cluttering their own library.

2 Select & request

Tick the pieces you want and send one request. A cap per request keeps it fair and manageable.

3 Share a whole set

One link can carry many pieces at once (a “bundle”), not just one — so an admin fills a library in a single tap.

More than the notation

A piece needn't be just a PDF — your library can hold everything that goes with it.

Class recordings

Keep the recording of the class a piece was taught in, right on the piece.

Audio clips

Reference renditions or your own practice takes, alongside the notation.

Your notes

Gamaka reminders, corrections, or the teacher's comments on a piece.

Links

Point to a YouTube rendition or any online reference for the piece.

The school's shelf

Beyond notation, Resources becomes the place for everything-but-the-pieces.

Theory & glossary

Raga and tala concepts, and a glossary of the terms we use.

Keerthana newsletters

The school's newsletters, gathered in one place.

Pronunciation & transliteration

Guides to reading and saying the lyrics.

App guides & FAQ

How to use the app, with answers to common questions.

All of it shared as bundles — the same link-and-import flow the pieces already use.

Also on the horizon

Bigger pieces we've mapped but wouldn't build until the library is settled with your group.

♪

Attendance marking

A simple tool for Akka to mark class attendance — with a report a student can ask for whenever they want it.

✎

Add-your-own helper

A guided way to bring in a piece you already have, matched against the master so nothing's re-typed.

⌂

One tidy backbone

A single, consistent way every piece is stored, so search, sharing and export all just work.

An About menu

An About menu — the version it's running, where the data comes from, and who made it.

About

The Keerthana App

Version 1.0

DATA SOURCES

Raga, tāla and composer data from the karnatik.com composition database (7,874 compositions).

WITH THANKS TO

Development —	Prabhakar
Teaching & guidance —	Uthra (Akka)
Digitising & admin —	Anu, Govind, Aravind
Testing —	the whole group

A short go-live list

A few housekeeping steps to settle before opening the app to more families.

1. **Lock down access**
   Turn on the members-only list (Idea 1) so it's not open to anyone.

2. **Move the master to Akka's account**
   So the library outlives any one person's work account — it's the school's.

3. **Set who's who**
   Confirm the real Teacher and Admin lists (Akka; Anu and the boys).

4. **Publish properly**
   A simple home page and privacy note, then open it to the group.

Seeing it live

Now let's open it and actually use it

On the big screen, Akka's iPad, and your iPad — all at once

Three screens, three roles

Each screen plays a part, so you can see the whole thing move between people.

The big screen

Laptop → TV

These slides, cast to Akka's TV. Later: the Manager view — adding a new piece to the master archive.

Akka's iPad

Teacher

Akka's own device, signed in as Teacher. She finds a piece, opens the notation, and shares to class.

Your iPad

User

Signed in as an ordinary student. The piece Akka shares lands here — live, on a different device.

The share from Akka's iPad arriving on yours is the moment worth watching for.

What we'll show you

Five everyday moments — and which screen each one happens on.

1. **Find & open a piece**
   Akka's iPad — from the whole library to the notation in seconds.

2. **Share a piece to the class**
   Her iPad → your iPad — the piece travels live. The heart of it.

3. **Plan a concert**
   Either iPad — turn a set of pieces into a printable running order.

4. **Add to the master**
   The laptop — the Manager view: a new piece into the archive.

5. **It travels with you**
   Any screen — phone, iPad, laptop: the same library everywhere.

Find & open a piece

The everyday move: browse or search, then open the notation, ready to teach.

1. **Browse the master**
   Scroll the whole library, newest first or by name.

2. **Search or filter**
   Type a song name; narrow by raga, tala or composer.

3. **Favourite**
   Star (★) the pieces you're teaching right now.

4. **Open the notation**
   Tap the document button — the PDF opens, ready for class.

Share a piece to the class

How a song travels from Akka to a student — live, across two devices.

1. **Akka taps Share (↗)**
   on her iPad, on any piece in the master.

2. **A link appears**
   she drops it into WhatsApp or the class group.

3. **It lands on your iPad**
   tap the link — the piece is in your library, notation open.

No files to send, nothing to organise — the song simply arrives on the other device.

Plan a concert

The Concert tab turns a chosen set of pieces into a clean running order.

1. **Add pieces**
   Tap + on any piece to drop it into the concert list.

2. **Put them in order**
   Move items up and down into programme order.

3. **Set the shruthi**
   Note the pitch for each item, right on the list.

4. **Open a notation**
   Each item opens its PDF from the list.

5. **Print**
   A clean running order for the day.

Add to the master archive

On the big screen: how a new piece gets into the school's canonical library.

1. **Open the master**
   On the laptop, the Manager view points at Akka's master archive.

2. **Add or Import**
   + Add one notation PDF, or ⇧ Import a whole batch at once.

3. **Auto-name & review**
   The app guesses raga / composer; skim and fix the review list.

4. **It's in the master**
   Rebuild (↻) — the new piece now shows for everyone.

It travels with you

Phone, iPad or laptop — the same library, wherever you open it.

Install once

Add to Home Screen from the browser — you get a Keerthana icon.

Opens like an app

Tap the icon; it opens full and clean.

Sign-in works

On iPhone it opens in Safari so Google sign-in just works.

Everything travels

Your library, shares and notation — on every device.

Put it on your Home Screen

Nothing to download from an app store — it is a website you add to your screen.

Android

phone or tablet · Chrome

1. Open the link below in Chrome.
2. Tap ⋮ at the top right.
3. Tap “Add to Home screen”.
4. Tap Install to confirm.

Windows or Mac

computer · a bookmark is fine too

1. Open the link below.
2. Click the install icon at the right end of the address bar.
3. No icon? Use the ⋮ menu:
   Chrome → Cast, save and share → Install page as app.
   Edge → Apps → Install this site as an app.

iPhone or iPad

Safari — not Chrome

1. Open the link below in Safari.
2. Tap Share (↗) at the bottom.
3. Tap “Add to Home Screen”.
4. Tap Add.

keerthana-music.github.io/library

The first time you open it

Three taps to get in. After that it remembers you.

1. **Tap the Keerthana icon**
   The one you just added to your screen.

2. **Sign in with Google**
   Tap the button and pick your Google account.

3. **Your shelf may be empty**
   Pieces appear once Akka shares a set with you.

If it looks wrong

No “Install” in the menu — you are likely in Firefox or Samsung Internet. Use Chrome, or just bookmark the page.

On iPhone the icon opens with the Safari address bar showing. That is normal.

Looks out of date — close it fully and open it again. It refreshes itself.

The road to launch

From today's demo to a schoolwide launch

Our target: Vijayadasami — Tuesday 20 October 2026

Three phases to Vijayadasami

Small and safe now, wider as we go — so launch day is calm, not a scramble.

1 · Now

this week

Demo to Akka.
Settle the two decisions.
Start the first scan batch,
to test the digitising flow.

2 · Pilot

August – mid-October

Akka, Vijay-sir, Govind & you
use it for real.
Digitise the ~500 krithis.
Tighten security; members-only.

3 · Launch

Vijayadasami · 20 Oct

Open to all Keerthana families.
Master on Akka's account.
Members-only switched on.
A simple home page + guide.

About ten weeks — comfortable, if the digitising starts now.

Getting the notation in

Akka's ~500 handwritten krithis, digitised once — then keeping it current is easy.

1. **Scan**
   The Brother scanner, double-sided, straight into a Drive folder.

2. **Suggest a name**
   A helper reads the title and matches it to our krithi list.

3. **Confirm in bulk**
   A person skims the guesses and fixes the odd one — fast.

4. **Into the archive**
   Named PDF + its details land in the master, ready to share.

After the bulk pass, new pieces go in one at a time with the Manager's Add button.

A team, not one person

So this rests on a few pairs of hands, not one — and stays tidy as it grows.

The maintenance team

Prabhakar & Govind now, with a few more volunteers joining as we go.

What they do

Scan, name and upload pieces; keep the ragam and composer lists tidy.

Small, clear jobs

Each person owns a slice — a batch of krithis, or one upkeep task.

Involved early

Learn the simple flow now, so launch isn't a last-minute rush.

Two things — and your thoughts

To make it truly the school's, and to point us where to go next.

1. **The enrolled families list**
   So we can switch on members-only access — today the link is open to anyone.

2. **Move the master to your account**
   So the library is the school's, not tied to one work login.

3. **Your feedback**
   What feels right, what's missing, what you'd change.

Thank you, Akka — this is your library.